



Model of a Sumerian plow

PLOW

The plow was developed in East Asia by 5000 BCE. It was a blade attached to a wooden frame that prepared soil by cutting through the top layer, which brought nutrients to the surface. Plowing created trenches, called furrows, where seeds were planted.

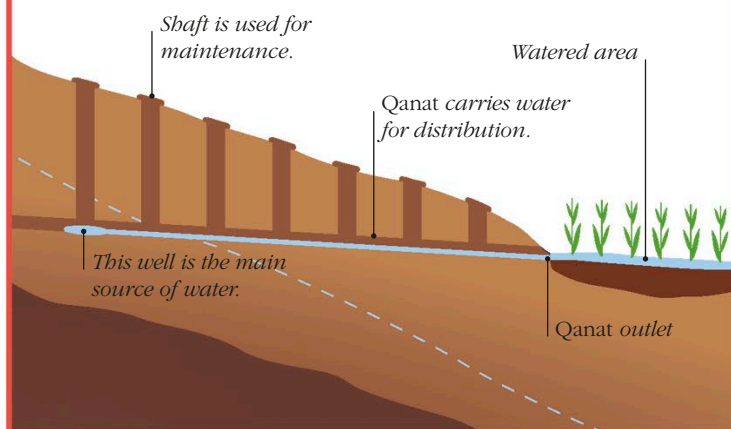
▼ SOIL PREPARATION

Farm implements, including the barrow, were usually hitched to oxen, like this one, or horses. Such animals were domesticated to help with farmwork and were used for food.



PERSIAN QANAT

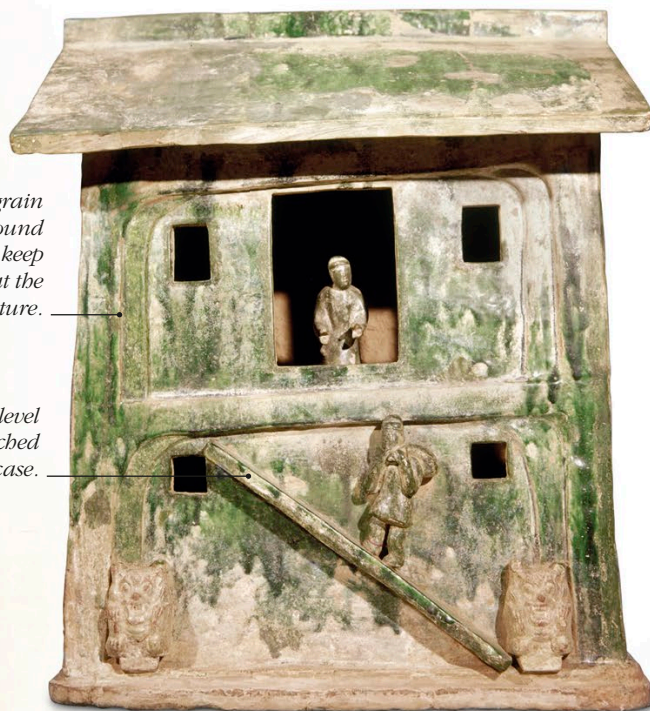
Water is essential to farming. In dry regions, some kind of system is needed to bring water to agricultural areas. In the early first millennium, the Persians did this by building underground canals. Called *qanats*, these canals sloped gently, helping gravity move the water. A *qanat* was usually around 3 miles (5 km) long, but some measured more than 40 miles (65 km).



Clay model of a granary, China, c. 150 BCE

Storing grain above ground level helps to keep it dry and at the right temperature.

Second level could be reached by a staircase.



GRANARY

In around 9000 BCE, the first grain stores, or granaries, were built in what is modern-day Jordan. These buildings were designed to store dry grain and other crops, such as rice, so they wouldn't spoil. People needed places to store crops that they didn't want to eat or sell right away.